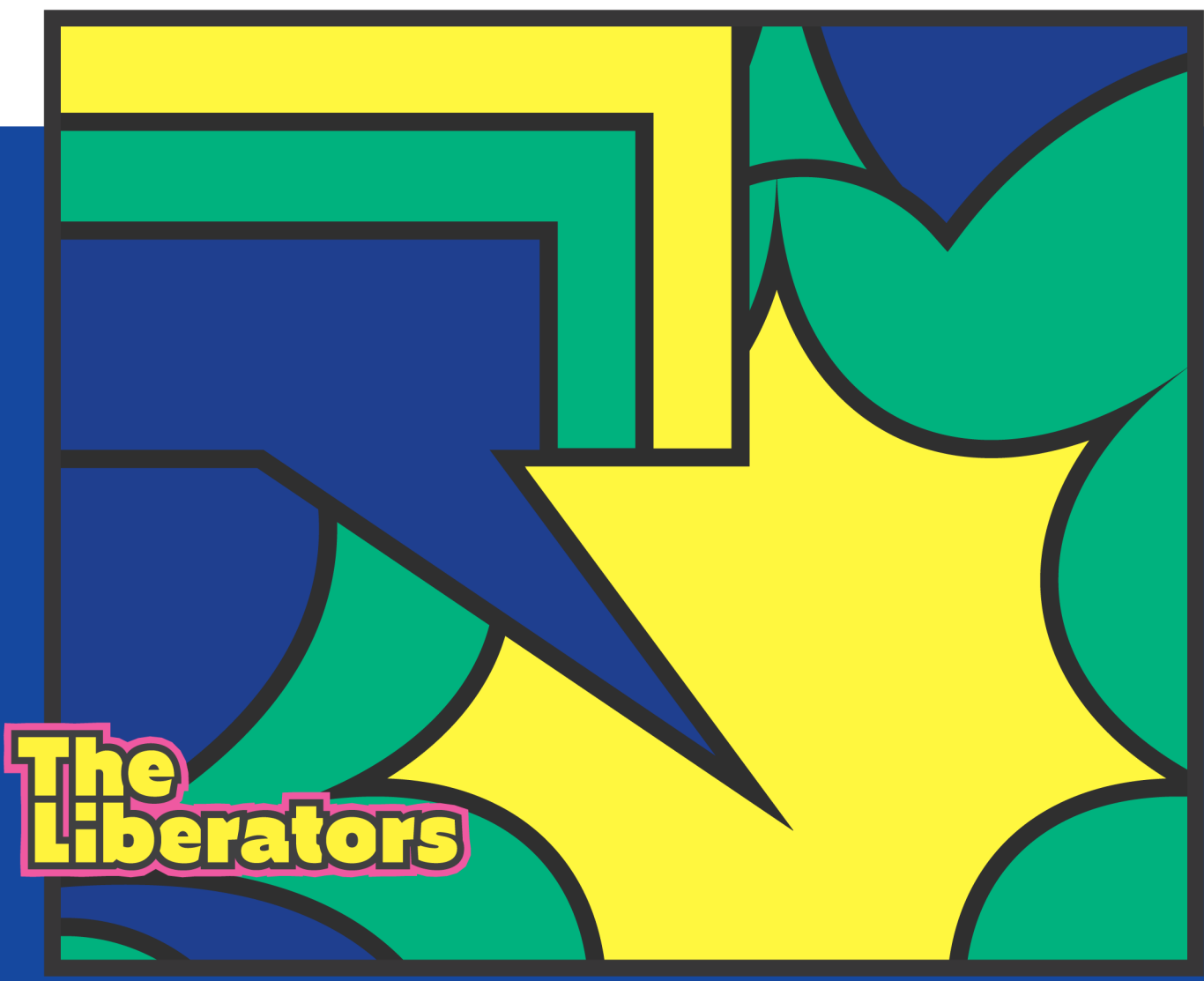


Conveying New Knowledge

How to interactively convey knowledge and concepts with students with the Liberating Structures Shift & Share and UX Fishbowl



**The
Liberators**

How to prepare



As an educator, one of your main responsibilities is to help students develop knowledge and explore concepts. But it can be challenging to keep students engaged.

This **exercise guide** offers two options for exploring new knowledge and concepts interactively. It is designed for:

- 5–50 students
- 30–45 minutes
- Classroom setting

To prepare:

- Optimize the learning space so students can move around and into groups easily.
- Prepare a surface to collect students' outputs, such as a board or a window.
- Provide paper or sticky notes and pens for each student.
- To quickly regain attention at the end of the short rounds, a high tone helps cut through noise. We often use Tingsha Bells.

Attribution

This guide was created by **Barry Overeem**, **Christiaan Verwijs**, **Prof. Margaret Anne–Storey**, and **Prof. Daniel Russo**.

Liberating Structures are created by Henri Lipmanowicz and Keith McCandless. Their mission is to unleash and involve everyone. Learn more at <https://liberatingstructures.com>.



 50 min

Option 1: Shift & Share



In Shift & Share, small groups of students collaboratively prepare a short 3-minute session on a paper, a concept, or a topic. The students then helping each other digest and understand the material.

Preparation

- Identify a handful of related topics for the students to explore. This can be a single paper, a book chapter, multiple papers, or theories.
- Create "stations" for each small group. A station has a visible topic, a poster surface (i.e., a whiteboard, flipchart, wall with stickies), and writing materials. Avoid digital tools if you can to keep this physical.

Steps

- **2 min** Present the topics. Ask the students to form small groups (3–5 people) and distribute them across the stations.
- **10 min** Ask the small groups to prepare a poster explaining their topic to the other groups, including what they learned and what is still unclear. This timebox can be longer, but we recommend keeping it below 20 minutes.
- **2 min** Ask the small groups to pick one "presenter" from their group. That person remains with the station throughout the exercise and explains their topic to the other groups. Invite the remaining students to rotate clockwise to the next station.
- **5 min** Give the presenters 5 minutes to share their poster with visitors and collect feedback. Encourage the visitors to dig deeper, and the presenter to update the poster with emerging insights and questions.
- **1 min** Ask the visitors at each station to stay together, and move to the next station (clockwise). The presenters remain at their stations.
- **20 min** Repeat the previous two steps three or more times.
- **10 min** Debrief as a group. At each station, what is still unclear? This is a good opportunity to teach.

Tips

- Keep the posters somewhere visible in the classroom to build a visual memory of learnings.
- We sometimes add a final sharing round in which students return to their original station to see what has emerged and share their insights with the presenter.



 30 min

Option 2: UX Fishbowl



In a UX Fishbowl, a small group of students shares what they have learned exploring a topic, while other students ask questions and dig deeper.

Preparation

- Create a small circle of chairs in the center of the room for 3–5 students that have explored some topic in detail as preparation. This could be a paper, a concept or their own experience with a topic.
- Place chairs for the other students in tight concentric circles around the inner circle.
- Have a flipchart available to capture questions and insights.
- Index cards or stickies are useful to collect questions.

Steps

- **2 min** Briefly set the stage and explain the rules. Only people in the inner circle speak while the other students listen with full attention.
- **10 min** Invite students in the inner circle to start a conversation about the topic with the others in the inner circle. They can structure this in whatever way works for them.
- **4 min** Halt the conversation in the inner circle. Now it is time for the students in the outer circles to generate questions for the inner circle based on what they've heard so far. To do this, ask the students in the outer circle to form pairs or groups of three. Each small group takes a few minutes to identify one shared burning question they'd like to ask the inner circle, and write it on an empty index card.
- **1 min** Ask the outer groups to give the index cards with questions to the inner circle. No discussion yet.
- **10 min** Ask the inner circle to collaboratively read and answer the questions as best as they can. Questions that remain unanswered can be captured.
- **5 min** Debrief as a group. As educator, this provides a good opportunity to address remaining unanswered questions.

Tips

- Prepare a few questions to get the first conversation started.
- Add a short personal reflection step at the end. Ask each student to write down one insight and one topic to dig deeper into.

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